

Tournaments

Overall	Salary	Brett	Gordo
Zhang	\$8900	1	1
Pavlovich	\$9400	2	
Dias	\$8600	3	
Haddon	\$9300		2
Ding	\$8400		3
Souza	\$7800		4

In tournaments, we have a lot of options. I went the easy route and ranked the best ITD options at the top, with Zhang and Pavlovich who are most likely to win in round one. Zhang is much cheaper which is why he's preferred of the two.

I also ranked Dias as someone in the mid-range with finishing equity, but there's lots of good targets to consider who we'll dive into more below.

Tier 1

9.5k-8.7k	Salary	Brett	Gordo
Zhang	\$8900	1	1
Pavlovich	\$9400	2	5
Song	\$9500	3	3

Haddon	\$9300	4	2
Tsuruya	\$8800	5	4
Asakura	\$9000	6	6
Matthews	\$9200	7	7

This range is filled with some strong targets and there are many different directions to take.

Song in the main event is the most expensive fighter on the board. He comes with safety, and upside, but not necessarily a guaranteed ceiling. I'm happy to pay up for him when I can but there's a good argument to make that Pavlovich and other early KO options may outscore him in a win. By default, Song isn't a must.

I expect Pavlovich and Zhang to be among the most popular fighters on the slate. Both have elite ITD equity, especially Pavlovich, and both are historically early KO options. I'd like moderate exposure to both. Of the two, Zhang is far more affordable and he fits in so much easier. Due to the cost, there's a better chance that Pavlovich wins and misses the optimal, which is why we both have Zhang ranked ahead.

I view Haddon, Matthews and Asakura as the primary pivots in this range, and I think all have merit. Haddon is my favorite, in what should be a super high paced fight. He'll need a certain outcome to hit a ceiling, but I like that he has scoring options, and I like that he'll come with a lower public ownership.

Asakura is another KO/bust option who is similar to Zhang and Pavlovich but hasn't hit in the UFC thus far. It should make him a

potential contrarian target. While I'm not confident in the outcome, I like getting exposure to Asakura as a pivot who carries similar upside to the other KO targets mentioned.

Matthews has been getting steam in the past day and he's a solid fighter. I think he can win and score well. He just almost never scores 100 points and my fear is that he'll look great and still fail to reach a ceiling. He's viable but not my outright priority.

Tsuruya is in a tier of his own as a cheap grappling option. I think he has some boom/bust elements here too and I don't trust his game. If he wins, it will come with wrestling and control, and probably a sub. I think he can exceed value and contend for the optimal in a win, so he's arguably a very strong play at the price.

I am likely fading Xiong this week as I think she needs a knockout, and I'm not betting on that outcome against Hill. She will be contrarian though.

Tier 2

8.6k-7.8k	Salary	Brett	Gordo
Dias	\$8600	1	4
Ding	\$8400	2	1
Perez	\$8500	3	3
Amorim	\$8200	4	5
Souza	\$7800	5	2
Lookboonmee	\$8000	6	

Vera	\$8300	7	6
Zhu	\$7900	8	7

I don't mind building the mid-range for tournaments this week. There is no real safety but there's a good chance we see a few of these fighters win and smash.

Dias is my favorite of the group, as he's the most likely to win on paper, and has a great ITD line. He can grapple and score 100 in a win, and that's all I need to know. Easy GPP target.

Ding vs. Souza could be an elite fight, although it's a bit boom/bust. Both guys can be hurt and Ding is super aggressive. I don't mind betting on a knockout in this fight and that's what Gordo likes too.

Perez and Amorim have a ton of grappling upside, so they are good tournament bets too. Both could easily lose and both are barely favored to win, which makes things tricky. But if you're factoring in what the score looks like in a win, both have great shots to exceed value and contend for the optimal. I'll be on both moderately by default.

I suppose I like Lookboonmee more than the public this week as I really think she can win. Her ceiling is not guaranteed which is the problem but I still think she's a viable contrarian/leverage target, who could score 80-90 and possibly find her way onto the optimal if another fight in this range busts.

Vera vs. Zhu is my least favorite fight. On paper, it's Vera trying to wrestle and Zhu trying to be a neutralizer. I like Vera some for grappling equity but I'm very concerned he won't dominate and

won't reach a ceiling. Zhu seems knockout dependent in my mind. Both are viable but I consider both low-end targets.

Tier 3

7.7k-6.7k	Salary	Brett	Gordo
Lee	\$7600	1	
Menifield	\$7300	2	4
Gurule	\$7400	3	2
Hill	\$7500	4	1
Sumudaerji	\$7700	5	
Teixeira	\$6800	6	3
Smotherman	\$7200	7	6
Harris	\$7000		5
Aoriqileng	\$6900		7

The bottom tier is kind of a shit show, and it's another range where you can pick and choose whoever you like.

I have Lee ranked the highest because I think a win for him is probably an early smash. We're lacking on data, and from tape I think Lee is terrible. But he's not a massive dog and may not be very popular. I'm fine betting on upside and backing that fight as a whole.

Similarly, Menifield will be leverage against Zhang and has a good shot for upside if he wins at all. Teixeira will be leverage against

Pavlovich, although he's more of a dart throw, that fight could end very quickly either way.

Gurule, Hill and Sumudaerji are my next favorite bets for a winner. The problem really is upside. You can choose to bet on upside, or bet on winners. I really am not sure any of these fighters will smash in a win, but I think I'd prefer exposure to them just in case. Gurule is a much better boxer than Tsuruya, Hill can produce volume, and Sumudaerji has some chance at a finish, albeit he's the msot boom/bust of the group.

Smotherman is another win equity option with some KO upside but we're starting to get thin here, and it's hard to be confident. Harris and Aoriqileng are in a similar tier, and I do like their upside better than others. If they win, I would expect a strong score. I think both are in pretty tough matchups and I'm not dying to bet on them winning.

Figueiredo is the other dart throw of the group, and he's the biggest dog on the slate. I'd much rather play nearly every other dog than him, so outside of a punt, I won't be on Figgy this week.